



APPS



The Browser Company launches a \$20 monthly subscription for its AI-powered browser

The [Browser Company](#) has launched a Pro subscription plan for Dia, its new web browser that heavily integrates AI features. The plan costs \$20 per month and provides unlimited access to Dia's AI-powered chat and skills features.

The introduction of a paid tier means free users will now face usage limits on AI features. While The Browser Company hasn't specified exact limits, CEO Josh Miller told [The New York Times](#) in July that the browser will remain free for those who use AI features "a few times a week."

IMAGE CREDITS: SCREENSHOT BY TECHCRUNCH

Miller also indicated that the startup plans to offer multiple subscription tiers, ranging from \$5 per month to hundreds of dollars monthly. The current \$20 plan appears to be one of several options based on different feature sets.

Earlier this week, users on [Reddit](#) and [Threads](#) noticed that The Browser Company had quietly made the Pro plan available online. However, the company quickly removed the page. Now the subscription option has been restored and can be accessed through Dia's settings page.

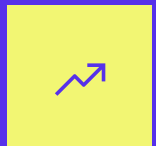
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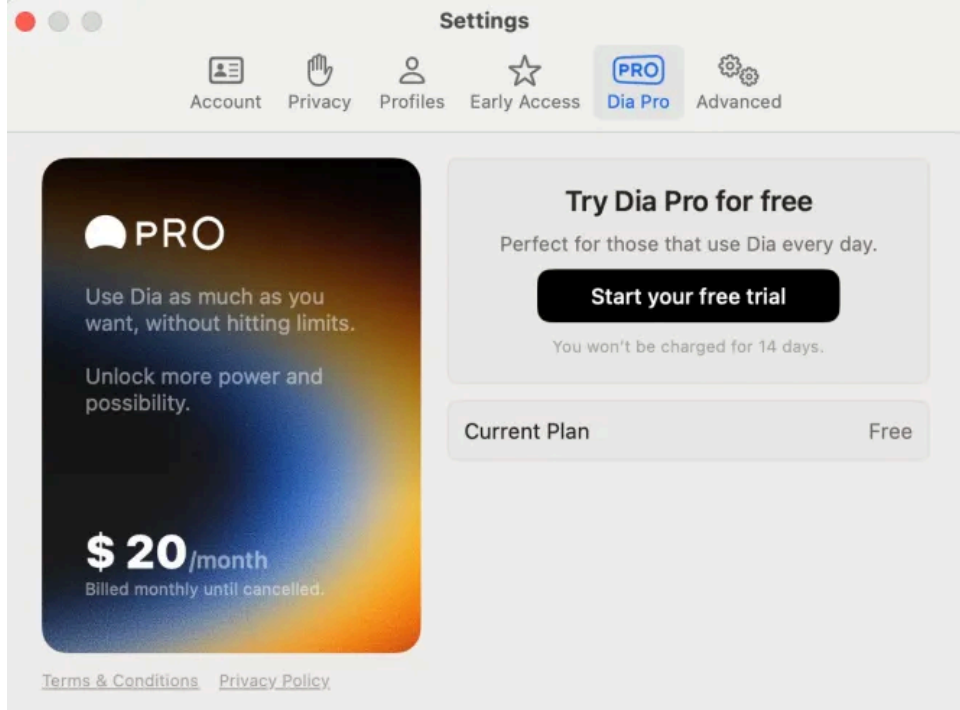
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SCREENSHOT

The Browser Company, which previously made [the Arc browser](#), has raised [\\$128 million](#) from investors, including Pace Capital, Next Play Ventures, and notable tech execs like LinkedIn's Jeff Weiner, Medium's Ev Williams, Figma's Dylan Field, Notion's Akshay Kothari, and GitHub's Jason Warner. This Pro plan represents the company's first revenue-generating subscription service.

The startup faces growing competition when it comes to AI-enhanced browsers. Perplexity's [Comet browser](#) is gaining steam, Opera is also prepping its [Neon browser](#), and incumbents like [Google](#) and [Microsoft](#) are also integrating their AI assistants into their browsers.



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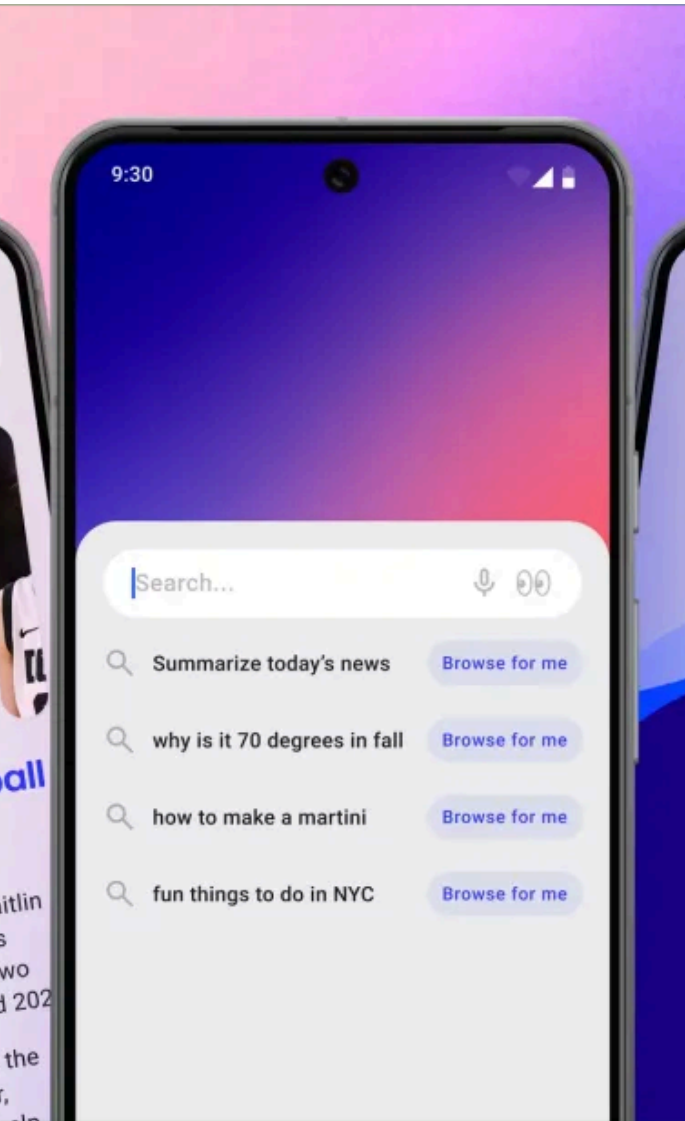


IMAGE CREDITS: THE BROWSER COMPANY

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Mobile browser Arc Search is now generally available on Android

Ivan Mehta — 7:00 AM PST · November 14, 2024

Following an [October beta release](#) for Android, mobile browser Arc Search hit general availability Thursday.

Its developer, The Browser Company, is known for its desktop browser Arc. To reach more users and employ AI-based search, the company launched [Arc Search for iOS earlier this year](#). The new version will possibly open up Arc Search's reach to millions of Android users.

When the startup launched Arc Search on Android, it had limited features, including Browse for Me, ad block, and auto archiving tabs. With the stable version, it gets [voice search](#), adaptable widgets, icons for the home screen, support for landscape mode, browse for me in your native language, and full Android 12 support.

The company said that within weeks of launching the open beta, more than 100,000 people had downloaded Arc Search through the Play Store.

While the Browser Company promises to keep releasing Android version updates, it's shifting its attention toward building newer products.

In [a video last month](#), Browser Company CEO Josh Miller said that while Arc is in its current version, the startup valued at [\\$550 million](#) is thinking about building new products that are more palatable to a wider audience.

Some users have complained that Arc is difficult to both learn and use, resulting in a loss of audience.

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In a conversation with [The Verge](#), Miller said that despite 4x user growth, the company understood that Arc isn't a mainstream product.

The Browser Company hasn't fully divulged details about what the final product might look like. Miller has claimed it will let users "glide around the internet" and get stuff done. The company also wants to build a powerful command bar that can help guide to the right result through AI. The company has shown off some of these features as [concepts or smaller functional releases](#) within the existing Arc browser.

The challenge for the startup will be balancing Arc power users, while developing a product with broader appeal.

Topics: [Android](#) [Apps](#) [Arc browser](#) [The Browser Company](#)



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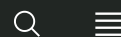


The Browser Company mulls selling or open

sourcing Arc Browser amid AI-focused pivot

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Since then, The Browser Company has been issuing bug fixes and security updates to Arc, but has stopped developing the app and adding features to it.

IMAGE CREDITS: THE BROWSER COMPANY

In [a new blog post](#), the company's CEO Josh Miller said Arc browser ran into a "novelty tax" problem.

"For most people, Arc was simply too different, with too many new things to learn, for too little reward [...] On top of that, Arc lacked cohesion in both its core features and core values. It was experimental, that was part of its charm, but also its complexity," Miller wrote.

The Browser Company doesn't plan to shut down Arc completely, but it said it has considered selling it or open sourcing it. However, Miller said the challenge in open sourcing the browser is that it is built on top of the Arc Development Kit, an internal SDK, which is also the core component of its new browser Dia, and it wouldn't want to give away that IP.

"While we'd love to open-source Arc someday, we can't do that meaningfully without also open-sourcing ADK. And ADK is still core to our company's value. That doesn't mean it'll never happen," Miller said.



powered browser

Ivan Mehta - 2 hours ago

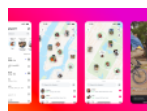
AI



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Aisha Malik - 14 hours ago

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Aisha Malik - 19 hours ago

Notably, [many Arc Browser users](#) have been asking the company to turn it into an open source project.



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The Browser Company's Dia browser is still in alpha testing. The company hasn't given a date for a wider release, but it said that it will make the browser available for testing to Arc members.

Topics: [Apps](#) [Arc browser](#) [browsers](#) [dia browser](#)

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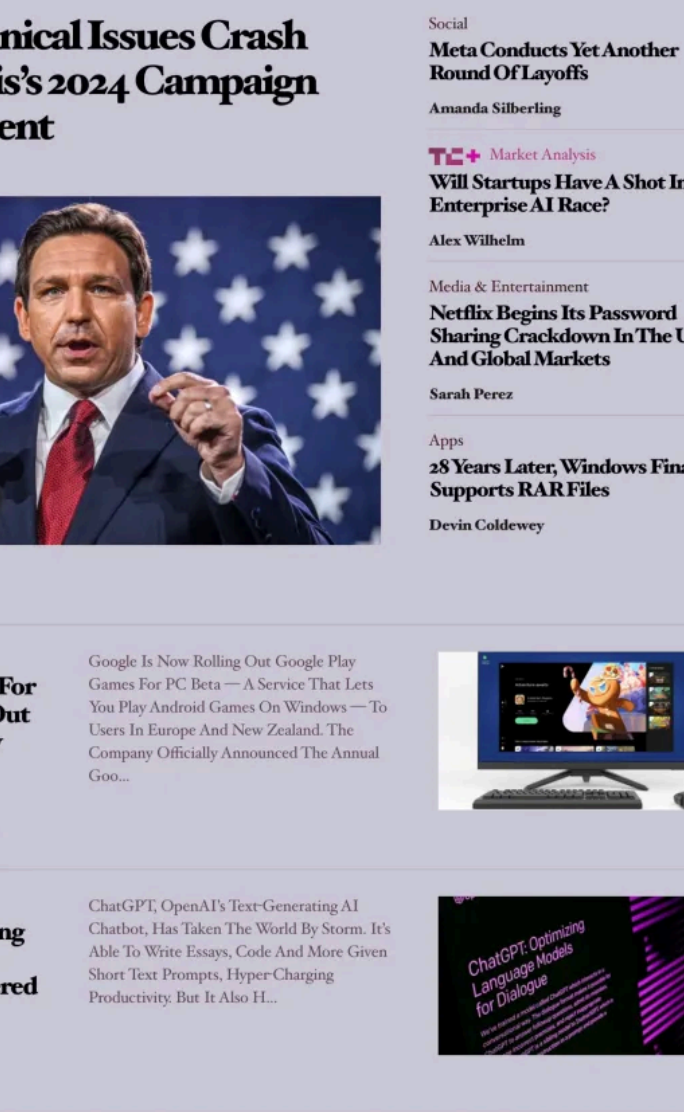
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Arc browser's new tool lets you remove some elements from a website

Ivan Mehta — 6:00 AM PDT · May 25, 2023

The Browser Company, the company behind the web browser Arc, introduced a fun new tool today called Boosts. It lets you customize a website with new colors and fonts. But the best feature of this tool is that you can “Zap” (read: remove) any element from a website, like a sidebar or a trending topic box.

Boosts originally launched in July of last year. The feature that was spearheaded by Chrome co-creator Darin Fisher and Victoria Kirst was focused more on developers. At that time, the tool focused on allowing developers to quickly put together a browser extension using JavaScript. The new version of Boosts is more end-user friendly, focusing on customizing the web pages or, as The Browser Company calls it, “editing the internet.”

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If you have installed Arc, tap on the plus sign in the bottom bar and select “Create new boost.” The Boosts toolbar lets you change the background and font color with advanced controls for brightness, contrast and original saturation. You also can change the font type to give the website a new look.

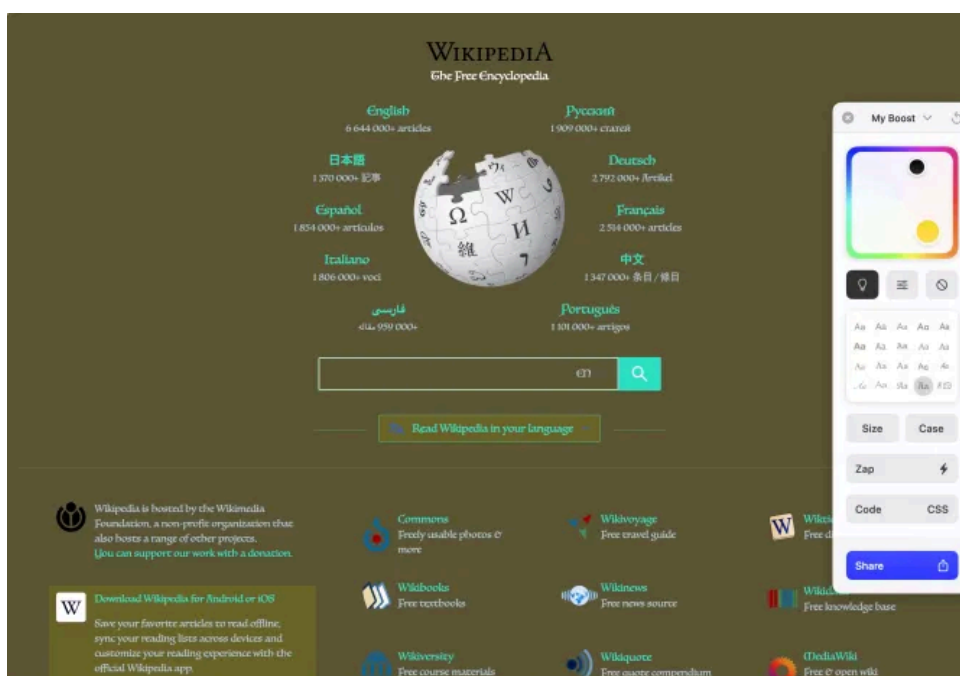
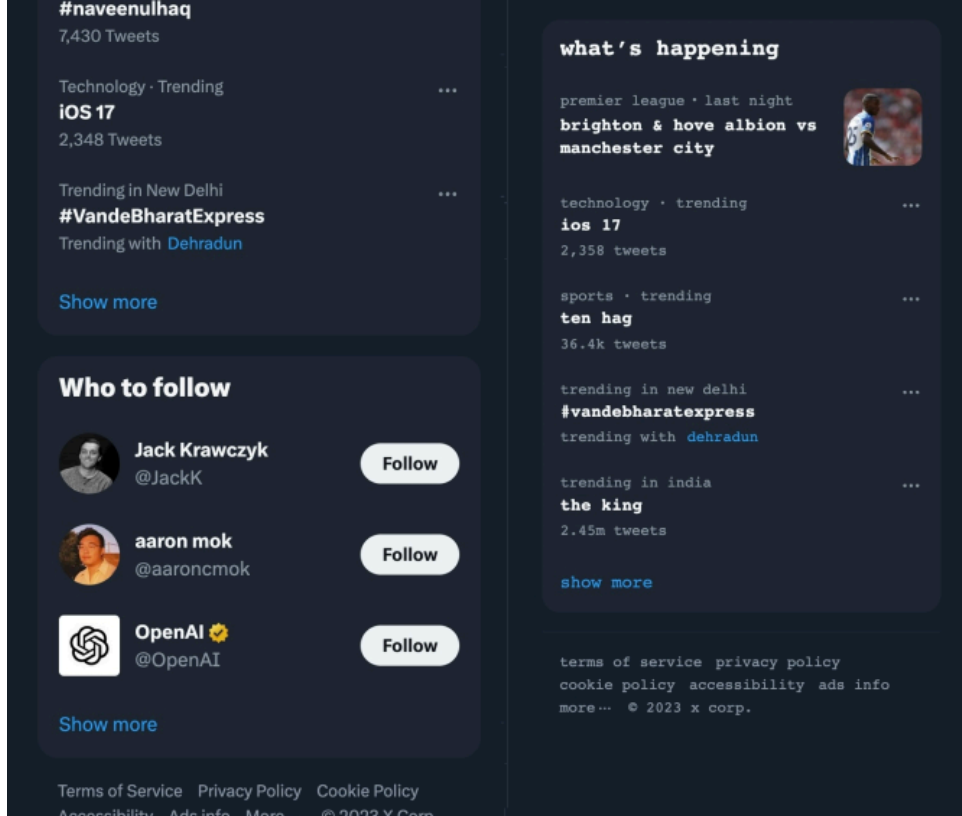


IMAGE CREDITS: SCREENSHOT BY TECHCRUNCH

Once you create a boost, you will see a paintbrush icon in the URL bar that quickly lets you enable or disable it.

The best part about Boosts 2.0 is the Zap tool that lets you remove elements. For instance, I removed the Shorts section on YouTube, because I didn’t want to see vertical videos on my system. Plus, I axed the user suggestion box off Twitter because I have mostly found it useless.



CHROME ON THE LEFT AND ARC ON THE RIGHT. IMAGE CREDITS:

SCREENSHOT BY TECHCRUNCH

Arc's development team has made it possible to share your boosts with other users as well. The browser has introduced a [Boosts gallery](#) that lets you see some of the edited web pages created by other users. You can click on "Get Boost" on any of these designs and apply it on the website.



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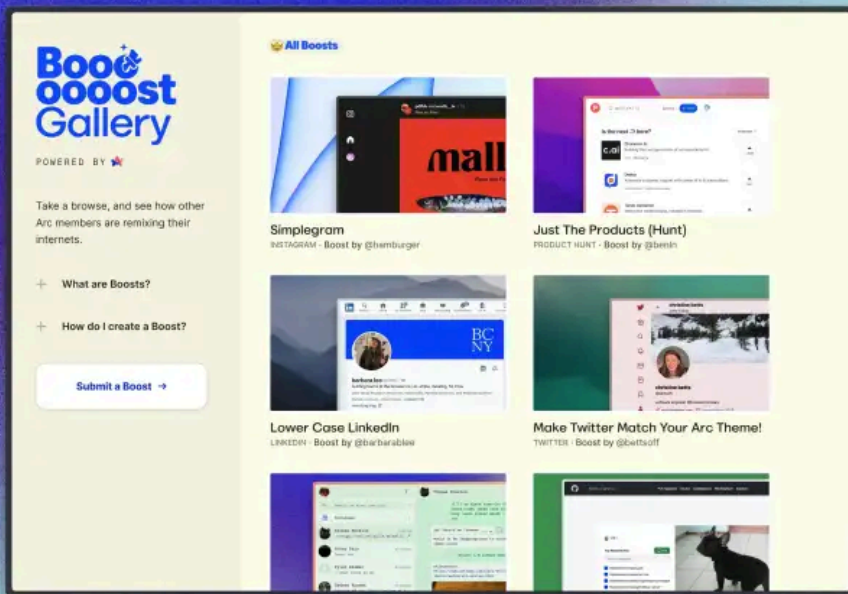


IMAGE CREDITS: ARC

The gallery has some great boosts to get started with. For instance, [this one](#) turns Instagram into a simple home feed without all the bells and whistles and [this one](#) gives Slack a serious look with serif fonts.

If you are a developer, you can still add JavaScript to your boost. But in that case, it won't be sharable with other users because of security concerns.

The idea of customizing a website is exciting — especially when you get to easily remove stuff that you don't like. Earlier this week, Chrome revamped its customization tools to [apply different themes and colors to the browser](#). However, Arc's customization is at the website level rather than the browser level.

In 2020, The Browser Company raised [\\$5 million in funding](#) from different investors like LinkedIn's Jeff Weiner, Medium's Ev Williams and Figma's Dylan Field. Their Arc browser is still in invite-only mode. Last month, the company launched [an iPhone companion app](#) for Arc that makes it easy for you to save different pages in different workspaces and access them later from the desktop.

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